

appliances like watches and calculators. A standard Casio calculator today uses the same LCD technology that the first displays in the 1960s did. This period also marked the beginning of the age old 'Plasma vs LCD' debate, a debate which still has proponents on both sides. The first of these displays were monochrome, and were a far cry from the lush colours that one finds on today's screens but they provided the basis for innovation to be carried forward.

Simultaneously, LED displays were also growing in complexity and were finding uses in many places, especially in the world of sign board advertising. The main problems that LEDs faced were the finite size of each individual lamp, which was reduced with each successive year. As



Early touchscreens were bulky and offered little functionality

the world of computerisation and mechanisation grew, so did the demand for diversified displays that could serve individual needs. There were new forms of displays that were evolving for specialised requirements. Split-flap displays like the ones that were common in airport arrival/ departure boards of the last decade and vacuum fluorescent displays that the annoying counter clerks at the local supermarket still use today are all inventions that were spawned during this period. This period also saw the